

Chapter 13 Test– Answer Key

Matching [Each correct answer is worth 1 point.]

Match each item to the correct answer.

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| <u>F</u> 1. Suffering | A. That which embodies or reflects God's character or design |
| <u>A</u> 2. Good | B. That which deviates from the good |
| <u>E</u> 3. Moral evil | C. An expression of grief, regret, sorrow, or sadness |
| <u>G</u> 4. Theodicy | D. Evil resulting from acts of nature |
| <u>C</u> 5. Lament | E. Evil brought about by the actions of personal beings |
| <u>B</u> 6. Evil | F. Pain or discomfort that results from natural or relational brokenness in the world |
| <u>D</u> 7. Natural evil | G. An attempt to defend God's goodness and justice by explaining his reasons for allowing evil |
| <u>H</u> 8. Sovereign | H. Possessing supreme power and authority |

Multiple Choice [Each correct answer is worth 1 point.]

Circle the correct answer(s) from the choices below. Some will have more than one answer.

9. Open theism . . .
 - a. is Augustine of Hippo's theory of the problem with evil.
 - b. tries to justify God by saying he doesn't know peoples' free-will decisions.**
 - c. is a type of theodicy.**
 - d. is an explanation for why some people believe in atheism.
 - e. is a false theory.**
10. The free-will defense attempts to explain . . .
 - a. how God and evil can coexist.**
 - b. that God and evil cannot coexist.
 - c. the evidential problem of evil.
 - d. that God created free creatures and cannot logically make them choose what's right.**
11. In the midst of suffering, what is an appropriate response?
 - a. lamenting**
 - b. crying out to God**
 - c. examining ourselves and repenting**
 - d. trusting that God is sovereign**

12. Some Eastern religions claim that . . .
 - a. **the physical world, evil, and suffering are all illusions.**
 - b. **the problem of evil is a problem of perception, and not a problem of objective reality.**
 - c. life is hard and evil just happens.
 - d. **good and evil are part of the same whole.**
 - e. **karma will give you what you deserve.**
13. What was part of the garden of Eden when God created it?
 - a. Satan disguised as a serpent
 - b. **shalom**
 - c. evil
 - d. **good**
 - e. **the ability to choose good or evil**
14. What passage is a great example of God's sovereignty?
 - a. **Colossians 2:15**
 - b. James 1:13
 - c. Psalm 22:1–2
 - d. Job 10:1–3
15. The logical problem of evil attempts to show that . . .
 - a. **there is an inherent contradiction between God's goodness and the existence of evil.**
 - b. **God and suffering cannot logically coexist.**
 - c. God's existence is highly improbable given the gratuitous amount of evil in the world.
 - d. suffering and evil are just a part of life.
16. Atheism's explanation for the problem of evil . . .
 - a. is a good theodicy.
 - b. **doesn't remove pain and suffering.**
 - c. **removes all hope.**
 - d. **claims that evil only makes sense in a world in which God doesn't exist.**

True or False [Each question is worth 1 point.]

Indicate if each statement is true or false. If the statement is false, change the underlined word to make it true.

F 17. The key verse James 1:13 is a great example of how to cry out to God. Psalm 22:1–2

F 18. God deals with the problem of sin by removing Adam and Eve from the garden of Eden.
taking responsibility for redeeming it

T 19. Jesus is called Immanuel because God doesn't stand by indifferently as we suffer; he sympathizes with us because he knows what it's like to be one of us. _____

F 20. “No, in all these things we are more than sinners through him who loved us” (Romans 8:37).
conquerors

T 21. Christians believe that natural evil can be traced back to the fall.

T 22. Even though we still suffer the consequences of evil, the pain and suffering of
 Christians is not meaningless.

F 23. The idea that because God is omniscient, all evil in this world is God’s direct will for us
 is a true theodicy. fallacious or false

**Fill-in-the-blank [Each answer is worth 2 points. Question 24 is worth 6 points and
 Question 27 is worth 4 points.]**

Fill in the missing word(s) to complete each statement.

24. “As for you, you meant evil against me, but God meant it for
good” (Genesis 50:20).

25. Jesus’ victory was sealed when he showed that death too had no
 power over him.

26. When we lament, we express our anguish without attempting to
 offer explanations.

27. Natural and moral evil leads to suffering, which can cause us to
question God’s character.

Short Answer [Each question is worth 3 points.]

Answer the following questions using complete sentences.

28. List three of the four ways the church responds to evil.

Answers will vary but should include three of the following: The church laments. The church recognizes that suffering is an essential part of our calling as Christians. The church fights against evil and anticipates Christ’s final restoration by working for good here and now. The most important way is that the church prays.

29. Consider God’s conversation with Job. How does Job respond to God?

Job declares that God can do all things and his purposes can never be thwarted. He acknowledges his limited understanding and repents. In seeing God, Job finds himself once again able to trust.

30. What is a simple way to explain how God took the responsibility to solve the problem of evil and suffering?

God takes responsibility for our sinful nature by becoming one of us and experiencing everything humans do with the exception of sin. Jesus took on the full weight of human evil and let himself be crushed by it when he died for us on the cross.

Essay [Each question is worth 5 points.]

Answer the following questions with at least one paragraph.

31. Suppose a friend asked you how Christians approach the problem of evil. How would you explain it?

Possible answer: I would explain that in the beginning, God said his creation was good—there was no evil. Where evil came from is not clear in the Bible. There is reason to believe that evil began with the rebellion of Satan. When Adam and Eve fell to Satan’s temptation to disobey God, sin entered the world. When humans chose to rebel against God, the consequences of their choices led to more evil, as well as the pollution and corruption of God’s good creation. God did not create evil, but he did create beings with the ability to choose good or evil. Therefore, God made evil possible, but Satan and humans made it actual.

32. Explain the two assumptions in the logical problem of evil argument. Include why those assumptions are faulty.

The first faulty assumption is that since God is all-powerful, he can create any world that he wants. This fails to take into consideration that God is a logical God. He will not contradict his nature by doing something illogical to him. If God wants a world in which humans have free will, he cannot also have a world in which people are not allowed to make evil decisions. The second faulty assumption is that if God is all-loving, he must obviously prefer a world without suffering. However, experience and history show us there have been some good things that come out of suffering. So, it is possible that God has some good reason for permitting evil and suffering.

33. Evaluate the atheistic view of the problem of evil.

Possible answer: We can claim that certain things are evil only because we have an idea of what is good. If there is no God, as atheists claim, then there is no objective good, which means there can be no objective evil either. So, the atheist cannot call something evil without accepting there is an objective good, which is not possible without God’s existence. Also, the atheistic view leaves no room for hope or justice in this life.

34. What are two reasons why Stephen Fry’s evidential problem of evil argument is faulty?

Fry’s argument assumes we’re able to know that God has no good reason for permitting suffering. However, our finite minds cannot know everything an infinite God would know. Also, if Fry’s argument is to support atheism, then the problem of suffering must outweigh all other evidence for God’s existence—including the cosmological, design, and moral arguments, as well as the evidence of Jesus’ physical resurrection.